



“USB 3.0 WILL BE AVAILABLE ON SELECT NOTEBOOKS BY OCTOBER”

Anurag Arora is responsible for developing product strategies for driving growth of HP business notebooks countrywide. Recently, he spoke to Uma Bansal of EFY about the trends in the notebooks market. Excerpts:

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It's a common belief that obsolete stuff is sold to small and medium enterprises (SMEs). What's your take on that?

We at HP completely disagree with this; for us the SME segment or the emerging enterprises is where the next level of growth will come from. This segment is extremely professional and desires high levels of efficiency and competency to be able to compete globally. And this cannot come from obsolete, old or redundant computers.

What notebook features should the SMEs look for?

Hard drive protection, panel protection, spill-resistant keyboard and tough casing ensure the notebook withstands the rigours of the busy executive usage. One-touch access to productivity functions makes it simple to use the hi-tech features of the notebook. Security features ensure not just physical protection to the notebook but also protection of the invaluable data inside the notebook from unauthorised access.

What's the latest in notebook components?

Availability of 1 GB of dedicated professional graphics memory, Dream colour display panel for better colour accuracy, brushed aluminium casing that is scratchproof, and primary battery that gives more than ten hours of backup are some of the new offerings in notebook category. Quad-core processors are now available from Intel and memory will slowly move from DDR2 to DDR3, though the performance difference is not substantial. In due course of time, with lesser cost and more storage space, solidstate drives will replace hard disk drives.

By when do you see USB 3.0 happening to notebooks?

USB 3.0 will be available on select notebooks, especially mobile workstations, by September-October this year. It will be of use for those who have to transfer large chunk of data between devices and those who use USB port to charge mobile phones and other devices.

Portability also makes notebooks prone to theft. What security features can we expect to counter this problem?

HP Protect Tools ensure security of not only the notebook

PC but also the data. Security manager helps protect the notebook, confidential data and network from unauthorised access. Device access manager helps keep unauthorised users from transferring or removing your data, and block USB drives that can cause the spread of viruses and malware. Trusted module platform (TPM) chip provides enhanced hardware-based protection for data and credentials. Drive lock password-protected in TPM hardware improves security by requiring users to authenticate before accessing the hard drive—without the need to memorise another password. BIOS configuration allows easy access to features such as power-on user and administrator password management, and easy configuration of pre-boot authentication features. HP PC tracing and data security service allows users to trace the location of their notebook if lost or stolen.

How do the notebooks manage to run cool despite their small size and increase in processing power?

Notebook form factor, internal design, cooling vent, fan, processor, etc decide the cooling technology in a notebook. Notebooks with smaller form factors, especially those with 30.5cm screen and less than 1.5 kg in weight, are powered with low-voltage processors to reduce the heating and achieve maximum battery backup.

Earlier it was desktops vs notebooks. Today, it is notebooks vs notebooks. What will be the ultimate winner?

Given the growing usage of notebooks today and also the varied profiles of people, it's not one category eating into other's share but it's about co-existence of both. Different people have different requirements. For some a netbook is the best option, while for others a notebook.

Notebooks promise a different experience and these will get just better from here on; in terms of features, looks and functionality. But, of course, they have both their strengths and weaknesses. Netbooks are high on battery life, have compact size and come at really affordable rates, making them potentially more appealing to the most mobile of notebook users. But because of lower processor speeds than notebooks, multitasking can be a challenge.